

Defense mechanisms

Ocean predators better watch out! Their prey are finding more and more inventive ways to avoid attack and protect themselves. Whether blending into the background to hide from hunters or fighting back with weapons, these marine animals are not going down without a fight.



Sting in the tail

The blue-spotted stingray would rather swim away than fight, so its bright, blue spots warn predators to back off. If it is attacked, the spiky stinger on its tail releases a deadly poison.

Poisonous spines

Deadly lionfish have poisonous spines that can kill other marine life and also paralyze humans. Their colorful spines can clearly be seen, and are a warning to predators to stay back.



Camouflage

The marine master of disguise is the cuttlefish. It can change its appearance very quickly. The cuttlefish can make its skin color and texture blend so well with its surroundings that predators can't see it.

